

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12411324
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Katayose; Masato

Zoom lens and imaging apparatus including the same

Abstract

A zoom lens L0 consists of a first lens unit L1 having negative refractive power, a middle group Lm including one or more lens units, and a last lens unit having positive refractive power. The first lens unit L1 includes a first negative lens, a second negative lens, and a third negative lens that are arranged sequentially in an order from an object side to an image side. The number of negative lenses included in the first lens unit L1 is four or less. The middle group Lm includes a plurality of cemented lenses each having a cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and includes a lens element Ln that is disposed closest to the image side among lens elements having negative refractive power included in the middle group Lm. The zoom lens L0 satisfies a predetermined inequality.

Inventors:	Katayose; Masato (Tochigi, JP)
Applicant:	CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)
Family ID:	84543100
Assignee:	Canon Kabushiki Kaisha (Tokyo, JP)
Appl. No.:	17/852195
Filed:	June 28, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220413270 A1	Dec. 29, 2022

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2021-108063	Jun. 29, 2021
----	-------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G02B15/14 (20060101); **G03B5/02** (20210101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G02B15/145523** (20190801); **G02B15/143507** (20190801); **G02B15/144515** (20190801); G03B5/02 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G02B (15/143505); G02B (15/143507); G02B (15/144511); G02B (15/144513); G02B (15/144515); G02B (15/145523); G02B (15/1465); G02B (15/145517); G02B (15/145519); G02B (15/145521); G02B (15/145525); G02B (15/145527); G02B (15/145529); G02B (15/145531); G02B (9/64); G02B (13/02); G03B (5/02)

USPC: 359/676

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
9958656	12/2017	Kawamura	N/A	G02B 15/1425
2013/0250160	12/2012	Neil	359/686	G02B 15/14
2013/0286257	12/2012	Tashiro	359/557	G02B 9/60
2019/0302431	12/2018	Kawamura	N/A	G02B 15/177
2021/0149168	12/2020	Uehara	N/A	G03B 5/00
2022/0269056	12/2021	Yamashita	N/A	G02B 15/144511

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2010176096	12/2009	JP	N/A
2013156477	12/2012	JP	N/A
2015094884	12/2014	JP	N/A
2017122743	12/2016	JP	N/A
2017129825	12/2016	JP	N/A
2019066653	12/2018	JP	N/A
2019066654	12/2018	JP	N/A
2020030251	12/2019	JP	N/A

Primary Examiner: Wilkes; Zachary W

Assistant Examiner: Hall; Elizabeth M

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Canon U.S.A., Inc. IP Division

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) The aspect of the embodiments relates to a zoom lens and an imaging apparatus including the

zoom lens, such as a digital video camera, a digital still camera, a broadcast camera, or a silver-halide film camera.

Description of the Related Art

(2) A negative lead type zoom lens is known as a zoom lens that has a compact entire lens system and easily achieves a wide angle. In the negative lead type zoom lens, a lens unit having negative refractive power is disposed closest to the object side.

(3) Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2010-176096 discusses a negative lead type zoom lens including five lens units.

(4) A negative lead type zoom lens has an asymmetric lens configuration, and thus has an issue of difficulty in correcting aberrations. For example, to achieve a wide angle of view with a negative lead type zoom lens, the refractive power of a first lens unit having negative refractive power is to be increased. However, in this case, aberrations such as magnification chromatic aberrations in a wide-angle range are likely to occur significantly.

(5) To provide a negative lead type zoom lens that ensures high optical performance while achieving a compact optical system and a wide angle of view, lens units that are arranged closer to an image side than an aperture stop are need to be configured appropriately in order to correct the aberrations that can occur at the first lens unit having strong refractive power. However, the zoom lens discussed in Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2010-176096 is not sufficient in this point.

SUMMARY

(6) According to an aspect of the embodiments, a zoom lens consists of a first lens unit having negative refractive power, a middle group including one or more lens units, and a last lens unit having positive refractive power that are arranged in an order from an object side to an image side. A spacing between adjacent lens units, among the lens units, changes in zooming. The zoom lens includes an aperture stop. The first lens unit includes a first negative lens, a second negative lens, and a third negative lens that are arranged in the order from the object side to the image side. A number of the negative lenses included in the first lens unit is four or less. The middle group includes a plurality of cemented lenses each having a cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and includes a lens element L_n that is disposed closest to the image side among lens elements having negative refractive power included in the middle group. The following inequalities are satisfied:

$$1.2 < |f_1|/f_w < 2.0,$$

$$0.5 < L_{1s}/L_{sn} < 1.8, \text{ and}$$

$$0.7 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 2.0,$$

where f_1 is a focal length of the first lens unit, f_w is a focal length of the zoom lens at a wide angle end, L_{1s} is a distance on an optical axis from a lens surface, of the zoom lens, disposed closest to the object side to the aperture stop at the wide angle end, L_{sn} is a distance on the optical axis from the aperture stop to a lens surface, of the lens element L_n , disposed closest to the image side at the wide angle end, and f_n is a focal length of the lens element L_n .

(7) Further features of the disclosure will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a cross-sectional view illustrating lenses of a zoom lens at a wide angle end according to a first exemplary embodiment.

(2) FIGS. 2A to 2C are aberration charts of the zoom lens according to the first exemplary embodiment.

- (3) FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view illustrating lenses of a zoom lens at a wide angle end according to a second exemplary embodiment.
- (4) FIGS. 4A to 4C are aberration charts of the zoom lens according to the second exemplary embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view illustrating lenses of a zoom lens at a wide angle end according to a third exemplary embodiment.
- (6) FIGS. 6A to 6C are aberration charts of the zoom lens according to the third exemplary embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view illustrating lenses of a zoom lens at a wide angle end according to a fourth exemplary embodiment.
- (8) FIGS. 8A to 8C are aberration charts of the zoom lens according to the fourth exemplary embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a schematic view illustrating an imaging apparatus.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

- (10) Zoom lenses according to exemplary embodiments of the disclosure and an imaging apparatus including any of the zoom lenses will be described below with reference to the attached drawings.
- (11) FIGS. 1, 3, 5, and 7 are cross-sectional views illustrating zoom lenses L0 at a wide angle end according to first to four exemplary embodiments, respectively. Each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments is an imaging lens system for use in an imaging apparatus such as a video camera, a digital camera, a television (TV) camera, a monitoring camera, or a silver-halide film camera. In each of the cross-sectional views of the zoom lenses L0, the left side is a subject side (an object side or a front side), whereas the right side is an image side (a rear side).
- (12) Each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments consists of a first lens unit L1 having negative refractive power, a middle group Lm including one or more lens units, and a last lens unit having positive refractive power. The term “lens unit” as used herein refers to the unit of movement in zooming (the elements of the zoom lens L0 that move or rest together in zooming). In other words, a spacing between the adjacent lens units changes in zooming. Each of the lens units includes one or more lenses. Each of the lens units may include an aperture stop.
- (13) In each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first and fourth exemplary embodiments, the middle group Lm consists of a second lens unit L2 having positive refractive power and a third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power. Furthermore, the last lens unit is a fourth lens unit L4 having positive refractive power.
- (14) In the zoom lens L0 according to the second exemplary embodiment, the middle group Lm consists of the second lens unit L2 having positive refractive power, the third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power, and the fourth lens unit L4 having negative refractive power. Furthermore, the last lens unit is a fifth lens unit L5 having positive refractive power.
- (15) In the zoom lens L0 according to the third exemplary embodiment, the middle group Lm consists of the second lens unit L2 having positive refractive power. Furthermore, the last lens unit is the third lens unit L3 having positive refractive power.
- (16) In each of the cross-sectional views of the zoom lenses L0, the zoom lens L0 includes an aperture stop SP. In the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, the aperture stop SP is disposed between the first lens unit L1 and the second lens unit L2.
- (17) In each of the cross-sectional views, an image plane IP is illustrated. In a case where the zoom lens L0 according to any of the exemplary embodiments is to be used for a digital video camera or a digital still camera, an imaging plane of a solid-state image sensor (a photoelectric conversion device) such as a charge-coupled device (CCD) sensor or a complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) sensor is disposed at the image plane IP. In a case where the zoom lens L0 according to any of the exemplary embodiments is to be used as an imaging zoom lens of a silver-

halide film camera, a photosensitive film surface is disposed at the image plane IP.

(18) In each of the cross-sectional views, a locus in zooming and a locus in focusing are also illustrated.

(19) More specifically, in the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, the first lens unit L1 moves toward the image side so as to draw a convex locus (a locus that moves toward the image side and then moves toward the object side) in zooming from the wide angle end to a telephoto end. With this movement, field curvature at an intermediate zoom region is appropriately corrected while a sufficient zoom ratio is ensured, but any other locus can be employed. The second lens unit L2 moves toward the object side in zooming.

(20) In the first, second, and fourth exemplary embodiments, the third lens unit L3 moves toward the object side in zooming from the wide angle end to the telephoto end. In the third exemplary embodiment, the third lens unit L3 is fixed with respect to the image plane IP in zooming.

(21) In the second exemplary embodiment, the fourth lens unit L4 moves toward the object side in zooming from the wide angle end to the telephoto end.

(22) In the first and fourth exemplary embodiments, the fourth lens unit L4 is fixed with respect to the image plane IP in zooming.

(23) In the second exemplary embodiment, the fifth lens unit L5 is fixed with respect to the image plane IP in zooming.

(24) In the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, focusing from an object at infinity to an object at short distance is performed by moving the second lens unit L2 entirely or partially toward the image side as indicated by a dotted arrow. In focusing, a plurality of lens units may be moved through different loci from each other.

(25) FIGS. 2A to 2C, 4A to 4C, 6A to 6C, and 8A to 8C are aberration charts of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments in a state of focusing on an object at infinity, respectively. The aberration charts of FIGS. 2A, 4A, 6A, and 8A correspond to the wide angle end. The aberration charts of FIGS. 2B, 4B, 6B, and 8B correspond to an intermediate zoom position. The aberration charts of FIGS. 2C, 4C, 6C, and 8C correspond to the telephoto end.

(26) In each spherical aberration chart, an F-number F_{no} is specified. In each spherical aberration chart, a spherical aberration amount with respect to a d-line (with a wavelength of 587.6 nm) is indicated by a solid line, and a spherical aberration amount with respect to a g-line (with a wavelength of 435.8 nm) is indicated by a two-dotted dashed line. In each astigmatism chart, an astigmatism amount ΔS at a sagittal image plane is indicated by a solid line, and an astigmatism amount ΔM at a meridional image plane is indicated by a broken line. In each distortion aberration chart, a distortion aberration amount with respect to the d-line is indicated. In each chromatic aberration chart, a chromatic aberration amount with respect to the g-line is indicated. A half-angle of view ω ($^{\circ}$) is also specified.

(27) Next, characteristic configurations and conditions of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments will be described.

(28) In each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, the first lens unit L1 includes three negative lenses (a first negative lens, a second negative lens, a third negative lens) arranged sequentially in this order from the object side to the image side. With at least three negative lenses arranged sequentially, the refractive power of each of the negative lenses is appropriately distributed, so that coma aberration, field curvature, and distortion aberration at the wide angle end are appropriately corrected.

(29) In each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, the number of negative lenses included in the first lens unit L1 is four or less. This prevents an excessive increase in size of the first lens unit L1.

(30) The middle group Lm includes a plurality of cemented lenses each having a cemented surface that is convex toward the object side. The inclusion of the plurality of cemented lenses in the middle group Lm enables appropriate correction of axial chromatic aberration and magnification

chromatic aberration in a wide zoom range. Especially, the inclusion of the cemented lenses each having the cemented surface that is convex toward the object side enables appropriate correction of magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(31) The middle group Lm also includes a lens element Ln having negative refractive power and disposed closest to the image side among lens elements having negative refractive power included in the middle group Lm. The term “lens element” as used herein refers to a single lens disposed with both of the surfaces in contact with air, or a cemented lens including a plurality of lenses cemented together.

(32) Each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments is configured to satisfy the following inequalities (1) to (3).

$$1.2 < |f_1|/f_w < 2.0 \quad (1)$$

$$0.5 < L_{1s}/L_{sn} < 1.8 \quad (2)$$

$$0.7 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 2.0 \quad (3)$$

(33) In the inequalities (1) to (3), f_1 is a focal length of the first lens unit L1, f_w is a focal length of the zoom lens L0 at the wide angle end, L_{1s} is a distance on an optical axis from a lens surface, of the zoom lens L0, disposed closest to the object side to the aperture stop SP at the wide angle end, L_{sn} is a distance on the optical axis from the aperture stop SP to a lens surface, of the lens element Ln, disposed closest to the image side at the wide angle end, and f_n is a focal length of the lens element Ln.

(34) The inequality (1) defines a ratio between the focal length of the first lens unit L1 and the focal length of the zoom lens L0 at the wide angle end in order to achieve a wide angle of view while appropriately correcting off-axis aberration such as magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(35) In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the first lens unit L1 increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (1) is exceeded, it is difficult to achieve a wide angle of view while achieving a size reduction of the zoom lens L0.

(36) In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the first lens unit L1 decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (1) is not met, it is difficult to correct off-axis aberration such as magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(37) The inequality (2) defines a condition for achieving both the correction of off-axis aberration at the wide angle end and the size reduction of the zoom lens L0.

(38) In a case where the distance from the lens surface of the first lens unit L1 disposed closest to the object side to the aperture stop SP increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (2) is exceeded, a diameter of the first lens unit L1 is upsized to ensure a sufficient amount of ambient light at the wide angle end.

(39) In a case where the distance from the aperture stop SP to the lens surface of the lens element Ln disposed closest to the image side decreases and the upper limit value of the inequality (2) is exceeded, on-axis light and off-axis light that pass through the lens element Ln are insufficiently separated at the wide angle end. In this case, it is difficult to sufficiently correct off-axis aberration at the lens element Ln.

(40) In a case where the distance from the aperture stop SP to the lens surface of the lens element Ln disposed closest to the image side increases and a lower limit value of the inequality (2) is not met, a size of the lens element Ln is upsized to ensure a sufficient amount of ambient light at the wide angle end.

(41) The inequality (3) defines a ratio between the focal length of the lens element Ln and the distance from the aperture stop SP to the lens surface of the lens element Ln disposed closest to the image side in order to achieve both the correction of off-axis aberration at the wide angle end and the size reduction of the entire optical system.

(42) In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens element Ln increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (3) is exceeded, or the absolute value of the focal length of the

lens element Ln decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (3) is not met, off-axis aberration is corrected insufficiently at the wide angle end.

(43) The above-described configuration provides the zoom lens L0 having high optical performance in a wide zoom range while achieving a compact size and a wide angle of view.

(44) In one embodiment, at least one of the upper and lower limit values of the numerical range of each of the inequalities (1) to (3) is set as specified by the following inequalities (1a) to (3a), or is set as specified by the following inequalities (1b) to (3b).

$$1.3 < |f_1|/f_w < 1.8 \quad (1a)$$

$$0.8 < L_{1s}/L_{sn} < 1.6 \quad (2a)$$

$$0.8 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 1.7 \quad (3a)$$

$$1.4 < |f_1|/f_w < 1.6 \quad (1b)$$

$$1.2 < L_{1s}/L_{sn} < 1.5 \quad (2b)$$

$$0.9 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 1.4 \quad (3b)$$

(45) Next, conditions that each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the exemplary embodiments satisfies will be described. Each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the exemplary embodiments satisfies at least one of the following inequalities (4) to (10).

$$2.0 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.6 \quad (4)$$

$$0.70 < f_{11}/f_{12} < 2.00 \quad (5)$$

$$1.0 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 3.0 \quad (6)$$

$$1.0 < f_L/|f_n| < 5.0 \quad (7)$$

$$70.0 < v_{d1n} < 100.0 \quad (8)$$

$$1.5 < f_{1n}/f_1 < 3.0 \quad (9)$$

$$35.0 < v_{dmp} - v_{dmn} < 70.0 \quad (10)$$

(46) In the inequalities (4) to (10), f_{mw} is a focal length of the middle group Lm at the wide angle end, f_{11} is a focal length of a negative lens L11 disposed closest to the object side in the first lens unit L1, f_{12} is a focal length of a negative lens L12 disposed adjacent to an image side of the negative lens L11, s_{kn} is a distance on the optical axis from the lens surface, of the lens element Ln, disposed closest to the image side to the image plane IP, f_L is a focal length of the last lens unit, v_{d1n} and f_{1n} are respectively an Abbe number and a focal length of a negative lens L1n having the greatest Abbe number with respect to the d-line among the negative lenses included in the first lens unit L1, v_{dmn} is an Abbe number, with respect to the d-line, of a negative lens of a cemented lens Lmc disposed closest to the image side among the cemented lenses included in the middle group Lm and each having the cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and v_{dmp} is an Abbe number, with respect to the d-line, of a positive lens of the cemented lens Lmc.

(47) The inequality (4) defines a condition for appropriately correcting aberrations over a wide zoom range while achieving the size reduction of the zoom lens L0.

(48) In a case where the focal length of the middle group Lm increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (4) is exceeded, the or each lens unit of the middle group Lm moves by a greater amount in zooming from the wide angle end to the telephoto end, and this makes it difficult to sufficiently reduce the entire size of the zoom lens L0.

(49) In a case where the focal length of the middle group Lm decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (4) is not met, it is difficult to sufficiently reduce variations in aberrations that occur in zooming.

(50) The inequality (5) defines a ratio between the focal lengths of the negative lenses L11 and L12 in order to achieve both the size reduction of the first lens unit L1 and the correction of off-axis aberration at the wide angle end.

(51) In a case where the focal length of the negative lens L11 increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (5) is exceeded, an outer diameter of the negative lens L11 increases, and this makes it difficult to achieve a sufficient size reduction.

(52) In a case where the focal length of the negative lens L11 decreases and a lower limit value of

the inequality (5) is not met, it is difficult to sufficiently correct off-axis aberration at the wide angle end.

(53) The inequality (6) defines a ratio between the focal length of the lens element L_n and the distance from the lens surface of the lens element L_n disposed closest to the image side to the image plane IP in order to appropriately correct off-axis aberration while ensuring telecentricity on the image side at the wide angle end.

(54) In a case where the absolute value of the focal length of the lens element L_n increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (6) is exceeded, it is difficult to sufficiently correct off-axis aberration at the wide angle end.

(55) In a case where the focal length of the lens element L_n decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (6) is not met, it is difficult to ensure sufficient telecentricity on the image side at the wide angle end.

(56) The inequality (7) defines a ratio between the focal length of the last lens unit and the focal length of the lens element L_n in order to appropriately correct off-axis aberration while ensuring telecentricity on the image side at the wide angle end.

(57) In a case where the focal length of the last lens unit increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (7) is exceeded, it is difficult to ensure sufficient telecentricity on the image side at the wide angle end.

(58) In a case where the focal length of the last lens unit decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (7) is not met, it is difficult to satisfactorily correct off-axis aberration at the wide angle end.

(59) The inequality (8) defines a range of the Abbe number of a negative lens included in the first lens unit L_1 in order to appropriately correct axial chromatic aberration and magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(60) The inclusion of at least one negative lens satisfying the inequality (8) in the first lens unit L_1 makes it possible to correct axial chromatic aberration and magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end more appropriately. In a case where an upper or lower limit value of the inequality (8) is exceeded (not met), axial chromatic aberration and magnification chromatic aberration are often corrected excessively or insufficiently.

(61) The inequality (9) defines a ratio between the focal length of the negative lens L_{1n} and the focal length of the first lens unit L_1 in order to appropriately correct axial chromatic aberration and magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end while appropriately correcting the other off-axis aberrations.

(62) In a case where the focal length of the negative lens L_{1n} increases and an upper limit value of the inequality (9) is exceeded, it is difficult to sufficiently correct axial chromatic aberration and magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(63) In a case where the focal length of the negative lens L_{1n} decreases and a lower limit value of the inequality (9) is not met, it is difficult to correct off-axis aberration such as coma aberration or field curvature at the wide angle end.

(64) The inequality (10) defines a difference between the Abbe numbers of the negative and positive lenses of the cemented lens L_{mc} in order to appropriately correct magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end.

(65) Configuring the cemented lens L_{mc} to satisfy the inequality (10) makes it possible to correct magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end more appropriately. In a case where an upper or lower limit value of the inequality (10) is exceeded (not met), magnification chromatic aberration at the wide angle end is often corrected excessively or insufficiently.

(66) In one embodiment, at least one of the upper and lower limit values of each of the inequalities (4) to (10) is a value defined by the following inequalities (4a) to (10a).

$$2.2 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.4 \quad (4a)$$

$$0.75 < f_{11}/f_{12} < 1.95 \quad (5a)$$

$$1.3 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 2.8 \quad (6a)$$

$$1.3 < f_L/|f_n| < 4.0 \quad (7a)$$

$$75.0 < v_{d1n} < 98.0 \quad (8a)$$

$$1.7 < f_{1n}/f_1 < 2.7 \quad (9a)$$

$$40.0 < v_{dmp} - v_{dmn} < 65.0 \quad (10a)$$

(67) Further, in another embodiment, at least one of the upper and lower limit values of each of the inequalities (4) to (10) is a value defined by the following inequalities (4b) to (10b).

$$2.4 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.2 \quad (4b)$$

$$0.80 < f_{11}/f_{12} < 1.90 \quad (5b)$$

$$1.5 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 2.7 \quad (6b)$$

$$1.7 < f_L/|f_n| < 3.5 \quad (7b)$$

$$80.0 < v_{d1n} < 96.0 \quad (8b)$$

$$1.9 < f_{1n}/f_1 < 2.5 \quad (9b)$$

$$45.0 < v_{dmp} - v_{dmn} < 60.0 \quad (10b)$$

(68) Next, a configuration of each of the zoom lenses L0 according to the exemplary embodiments will be described in more detail. The zoom lens L0 may not necessarily have a configuration described below in implementing an exemplary embodiment of the disclosure.

(69) In the first to third exemplary embodiments, the first lens unit L1 consists of a first lens having negative refractive power, a second lens having negative refractive power, a third lens having negative refractive power, a fourth lens having negative refractive power, and a fifth lens having positive refractive power that are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side. In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the first lens unit L1 consists of a first lens having negative refractive power, a second lens having negative refractive power, a third lens having negative refractive power, a fourth lens having positive refractive power, and a fifth lens having negative refractive power that are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side.

(70) In the first exemplary embodiment, the second lens unit L2 of the middle group Lm consists of a first cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and a second cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and the first and second cemented lenses are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side. Furthermore, the third lens unit L3 of the middle group Lm consists of a third cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, a fourth cemented lens with a positive lens, a negative lens, a negative lens, and a positive lens cemented together, and a negative lens, and the third cemented lens, the fourth cemented lens, and the negative lens are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side.

(71) In the second exemplary embodiment, the second lens unit L2 of the middle group Lm consists of a first cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and a second cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and the first and second cemented lenses are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side. Furthermore, the third lens unit L3 of the middle group Lm consists of a third cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and a fourth cemented lens with a negative lens, a negative lens, and a positive lens cemented together, and the third and fourth cemented lenses are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side. Furthermore, the fourth lens unit L4 of the middle group Lm consists of a fifth cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together.

(72) In the third exemplary embodiment, the middle group Lm consists of a first cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, a second cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, a third cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, a fourth cemented lens with a negative lens, a negative lens, and a positive lens cemented together, and a negative lens.

(73) In the fourth exemplary embodiment, the second lens unit L2 of the middle group Lm consists

of a first cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and a second cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, and the first and second cemented lens are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side. Furthermore, the third lens unit L3 of the middle group Lm consists of a third cemented lens with a negative lens and a positive lens cemented together, a fourth cemented lens with a negative lens, a negative lens, and a positive lens cemented together, and a negative lens, and the third cemented lens, the fourth cemented lens, and the negative lens are arranged in this order from the object side to the image side.

(74) In the first to fourth exemplary embodiments, the last lens unit consists of a single positive lens. The above-described configuration makes it easier to ensure telecentricity on the image side in a wide zoom range while achieving a size reduction.

(75) Next, first to fourth numerical examples respectively corresponding to the first to fourth exemplary embodiments will be described.

(76) In each of the numerical examples, each surface of the zoom lens L0 is given a surface number i (i is a natural number) in order from the object side. Furthermore, a curvature radius r (mm) of the surface, a lens thickness or a distance (air spacing) d (mm) on the optical axis between the surfaces with the surface numbers i and (i+1), a refractive index nd, with respect to the d-line, of a material of an optical member including the surface, and an Abbe number vd, with respect to the d-line, of the material of the optical member including the surface are specified.

(77) The Abbe number vd is a value defined by the relation $vd = (Nd - 1) / (NF - NC)$, where NF, Nd, and NC are refractive indexes of the material with respect to an F-line (with a wavelength of 486.1 nm), the d-line (with a wavelength of 587.6 nm), and a C-line (with a wavelength of 656.3 nm), respectively.

(78) In surface data, an aspheric surface is indicated with an asterisk (*). An aspheric shape is defined by the following formula.

$$x = (h \cdot \sup{2/R}) / [1 + \{1 - (1 + k)(h/R) \cdot \sup{2}\} \cdot \sup{1/2}] + A4h \cdot \sup{4} + A6h \cdot \sup{6} + A8h \cdot \sup{8} + A10h \cdot \sup{10}$$
, where k is an eccentricity, A4, A6, A8, A10 . . . are aspheric coefficients, x is a displacement (from a surface vertex as a reference) in an optical axis direction at a height h from the optical axis, and R is a paraxial curvature radius.

(79) Furthermore, a total lens length is a length obtained by adding a back focus to the distance on the optical axis from the frontmost surface of the zoom lens L0 (i.e., the lens surface disposed closest to the object side) to the last surface of the zoom lens L0 (i.e., the lens surface disposed closest to the image side). The back focus is the distance from the last surface of the zoom lens L0 to the image plane IP (the paraxial image plane).

First Numerical Example

(80) TABLE-US-00001 Unit: mm Surface Data Surface Number r d nd vd 1* 56.099 3.50 1.77250 49.6 2 24.246 8.52 3 34.584 2.30 1.95375 32.3 4 17.382 8.52 5* 200.682 2.30 1.58313 59.4 6* 20.705 10.73 7 -101.447 1.20 1.49700 81.5 8 18.222 4.62 1.73800 32.3 9 478.584 (variable) 10 (aperture) ∞ (variable) 11 23.744 1.00 1.92286 18.9 12 10.960 6.27 1.79952 42.2 13 673.725 0.84 14 -42.651 1.00 1.90043 37.4 15 13.238 5.04 1.89286 20.4 16 -61.427 (variable) 17 25.139 1.20 2.00100 29.1 18 14.087 4.82 1.49700 81.5 19 19447.656 0.15 20 22.378 6.50 1.49700 81.5 21 -22.245 0.20 22 -49.519 1.10 1.90043 37.4 23 46.100 0.20 24 21.126 1.50 2.00100 29.1 25 13.367 7.91 1.49700 81.5 26 -66.503 1.40 27 -27.449 1.50 1.85400 40.4 28* -60.322 (variable) 29 -133.157 4.74 1.51633 64.1 30 -40.481 15.09 Image Plane ∞ Aspherical Data 1.sup.st Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = 8.54297e-006 A6 = -8.01798e-009 A8 = 1.13131e-011 A10 = -8.67813e-015 A12 = 4.66323e-018 5.sup.th Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = 8.35841e-005 A6 = -3.26135e-007 A8 = 5.57011e-010 A10 = 4.18922e-015 6.sup.th Surface K = -1.40479e+000 A4 = 1.30666e-004 A6 = -2.26421e-007 A8 = -1.41303e-009 A10 = 7.47871e-012 28.sup.th Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = 3.33336e-005 A6 = 4.06563e-008 A8 = -2.92759e-010 A10 = 1.68963e-013 Various Data 1.88 Zoom Ratio Wide Angle Intermediate

Telephoto Focal Length 10.30 14.90 19.40 F-number 4.12 4.12 4.12 Half-Angle of 62.03 54.38
48.12 View (degrees) Image Height 19.40 20.80 21.64 Total Lens Length 129.14 128.47 132.69 BF
15.09 15.09 15.09 d9 17.80 7.34 2.00 d10 1.30 1.48 1.50 d16 2.64 2.46 2.44 d28 5.26 15.05 24.61
Zoom Lens Unit Data Group Start Surface Focal Length 1 1 -14.49 2 11 49.35 3 17 56.81 4 29
110.72 Single Lens Data Lens Start Surface Focal Length 1 1 -58.06 2 3 -39.20 3 5 -39.78 4 7
-30.98 5 8 25.56 6 11 -22.92 7 12 13.88 8 14 -11.12 9 15 12.60 10 17 -33.85 11 18 28.36 12 20
23.59 13 22 -26.37 14 24 -40.25 15 25 23.16 16 27 -60.25 17 29 110.72

Second Numerical Example

(81) TABLE-US-00002 Unit: mm Surface Data Surface Number r d nd vd 1* 41.574 3.50
1.58313 59.4 2* 13.158 8.70 3 62.750 2.30 1.77250 49.6 4 21.374 6.69 5* 137.929 2.30
1.85400 40.4 6* 27.160 6.58 7 -33.966 1.20 1.49700 81.5 8 33.106 0.20 9 27.579 6.16
1.73800 32.3 10 -57.136 (variable) 11 (aperture) ∞ (variable) 12 16.161 1.00 1.92286 18.9 13
10.885 4.57 1.57840 62.8 14 165.918 1.11 15 -50.285 1.00 1.87070 40.7 16 12.492 4.81 1.84666
23.9 17 -54.788 (variable) 18 18.101 1.20 1.91082 35.3 19 12.663 7.47 1.49700 81.5 20 -18.043
0.20 21 -22.014 1.10 1.90043 37.4 22 -193.865 0.20 23 19.500 1.50 1.95375 32.3 24 12.666 7.22
1.49700 81.5 25 -58.816 (variable) 26* -77.191 1.50 1.85400 40.4 27 21.824 6.54 1.49700 81.5
28 -54.068 (variable) 29 -248.857 3.55 1.84666 23.8 30 -63.598 15.37 Image Plane ∞
Aspherical Data 1.sup.st Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = -8.50776e-006 A6 = 1.14899e-008 A8
= -8.44163e-012 A10 = 3.70796e-015 2.sup.nd Surface K = -1.75103e+000 A4 = 3.67876e-005
A6 = -1.21075e-007 A8 = 2.76245e-011 A10 = 1.64998e-013 A12 = -1.20578e-016 5.sup.th
Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = 6.19388e-006 A6 = -8.51252e-008 A8 = 1.61905e-010 6.sup.th
Surface K = 2.88261e+000 A4 = 2.27718e-005 A6 = -2.18414e-008 A8 = 2.74384e-011
26.sup.th Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = -4.20828e-005 A6 = 2.55787e-008 A8 =
-4.64042e-010 A10 = 6.61699e-012 A12 = 4.68151e-015 Various Data 1.88 Zoom Ratio Wide
Angle Intermediate Telephoto Focal Length 9.27 12.80 17.46 F-number 4.12 4.12 4.12 Half-Angle
of 64.34 58.27 51.10 View (degrees) Image Height 19.30 20.70 21.64 Total Lens Length 124.52
121.90 125.00 BF 15.37 15.37 15.37 d10 19.78 9.25 2.00 d11 1.35 1.41 1.40 d17 2.66 2.73 2.71
d25 1.62 1.86 2.00 d28 3.13 10.67 20.92 Zoom Lens Unit Data Group Start Surface Focal Length 1
1 -14.47 2 12 50.84 3 18 33.54 4 26 -58.19 5 29 100.02 Single Lens Data Lens Start Surface Focal
Length 1 1 -34.58 2 3 -43.00 3 5 -39.98 4 7 -33.53 5 9 26.01 6 12 -39.74 7 13 19.92 8 15 -11.41
9 16 12.42 10 18 -51.72 11 19 16.29 12 21 -27.66 13 23 -42.45 14 24 21.70 15 26 -19.78 16 27
32.21 17 29 100.02

Third Numerical Example

(82) TABLE-US-00003 Unit: mm Surface Data Surface Number r d nd vd 1 34.400 3.50 1.58313
59.4 2* 16.622 10.11 3 40.381 2.30 2.00100 29.1 4 17.403 8.13 5* 90.700 2.30 1.58313 59.4
6* 27.050 6.71 7 -33.600 1.20 1.49700 81.5 8 35.822 0.20 9 30.640 5.08 1.78096 31.2 10
-75.913 (variable) 11 (aperture) ∞ 1.40 12 24.524 1.00 1.92286 18.9 13 12.510 4.95 1.82301 44.0
14 180.357 2.32 15 -59.078 1.00 1.87070 40.7 16 13.098 5.42 1.80810 22.8 17 -68.419 3.22 18
19.012 1.20 2.00100 29.1 19 16.008 6.10 1.49700 81.5 20 -25.440 0.20 21 -36.496 1.10 1.90043
37.4 22 103.580 0.20 23 18.461 1.50 2.05090 26.9 24 11.671 10.18 1.49700 81.5 25 -29.723 0.91
26 -24.961 1.50 1.85400 40.4 27* -72.116 (variable) 28 -264.561 4.01 1.48749 70.2 29 -55.806
16.34 Image Plane ∞ Aspherical Data 2.sup.nd Surface K = -5.53262e-001 A4 = -4.77532e-007
A6 = -1.10588e-008 A8 = 1.83751e-011 A10 = -1.16497e-013 5.sup.th Surface K =
0.00000e+000 A4 = 8.88984e-006 A6 = 7.13658e-009 A8 = -3.04399e-011 6.sup.th Surface K =
1.23047e+000 A4 = 1.72971e-005 A6 = 1.91288e-008 A8 = 1.94281e-010 27.sup.th Surface K =
0.00000e+000 A4 = 2.82781e-005 A6 = 2.15940e-008 A8 = -4.36051e-010 A10 = 1.38022e-012
A12 = -1.58613e-014 Various Data 2.05 Zoom Ratio Wide Angle Intermediate Telephoto Focal
Length 11.33 16.19 23.28 F-number 4.12 4.12 4.12 Half-Angle of 59.58 52.36 42.90 View
(degrees) Image Height 19.30 21.00 21.64 Total Lens Length 130.00 127.14 131.90 BF 16.34
16.34 16.34 d10 22.38 10.46 2.00 d27 5.54 14.61 27.83 Zoom Lens Unit Data Group Start Surface

Focal Length 1 1 -17.42 2 12 28.97 3 28 144.17 Single Lens Data Lens Start Surface Focal Length
1 1 -59.47 2 3 -32.17 3 5 -66.99 4 7 -34.69 5 9 28.55 6 12 -28.82 7 13 16.12 8 15 -12.23 9 16
14.02 10 18 -126.51 11 19 20.79 12 21 -29.86 13 23 -34.05 14 24 18.36 15 26 -45.37 16 28
144.17

Fourth Numerical Example

(83) TABLE-US-00004 Unit: mm Surface Data Surface Number r d nd vd 1* 56.725 3.50
1.58313 59.4 2* 16.247 8.00 3 47.182 2.30 1.85150 40.8 4 16.606 13.49 5* -27.537 2.30
1.43875 94.7 6* 48.093 1.58 7 31.644 5.30 1.73800 32.3 8 -46.000 0.40 9 -38.000 1.20
1.80400 46.5 10 -176.688 (variable) 11 (aperture) ∞ (variable) 12 20.075 1.00 1.92286 18.9 13
11.750 4.80 1.66672 48.3 14 -366.339 0.52 15 -54.856 1.00 1.87070 40.7 16 12.212 4.92 1.84666
23.9 17 -93.053 (variable) 18 16.685 1.20 1.91082 35.3 19 12.147 7.91 1.49700 81.5 20 -19.012
0.20 21 -28.442 1.10 1.90043 37.4 22 174.067 0.20 23 18.819 1.50 1.95375 32.3 24 11.822 9.62
1.49700 81.5 25 -29.854 1.00 26 -20.390 1.50 1.85400 40.4 27* -55.000 (variable) 28 277.215
3.50 1.84666 23.9 29 -157.100 13.00 Image Plane ∞ Aspherical Data 1.sup.st Surface K =
0.00000e+000 A4 = 2.73444e-006 A6 = -2.04458e-010 A8 = -1.10710e-012 A10 =
8.13351e-016 2.sup.nd Surface K = -1.08469e+000 A4 = 5.05865e-006 A6 = -4.69295e-009 A8
= 1.90605e-013 A10 = -1.15249e-013 A12 = 1.09903e-016 5.sup.th Surface K = 1.07137e+000
A4 = 5.95540e-005 A6 = -1.59697e-007 A8 = 1.46894e-010 6.sup.th Surface K = 3.15076e+000
A4 = 6.00822e-005 A6 = -1.25125e-007 A8 = -9.05637e-010 A10 = 3.54713e-012 27.sup.th
Surface K = 0.00000e+000 A4 = 3.81421e-005 A6 = 6.96414e-008 A8 = -6.50446e-010 A10 =
8.82367e-014 Various Data 1.87 Zoom Ratio Wide Angle Intermediate Telephoto Focal Length
10.50 14.59 19.69 F-number 4.12 4.12 4.12 Half-Angle of 61.70 55.21 47.70 View (degrees) Image
Height 19.50 21.00 21.64 Total Lens Length 123.70 120.84 123.60 BF 13.00 13.00 13.00 d10
19.92 9.22 2.25 d11 1.30 1.74 1.92 d17 3.29 2.85 2.67 d27 8.15 15.99 25.72 Zoom Lens Unit Data
Group Start Surface Focal Length 1 1 -16.00 2 12 54.80 3 18 51.87 4 28 118.87 Single Lens Data
Lens Start Surface Focal Length 1 1 -40.33 2 3 -31.17 3 5 -39.54 4 7 26.16 5 9 -60.45 6 12
-32.58 7 13 17.16 8 15 -11.39 9 16 13.03 10 18 -56.11 11 19 16.29 12 21 -27.08 13 23 -37.24 14
24 18.45 15 26 -38.71 16 28 118.87

(84) The following table shows various values according to the exemplary embodiments.

(85) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 1 Exemplary Embodiments 1st 2nd 3rd 4th (1) $1.2 < |f_l|/f_w < 2.0$
1.41 1.56 1.54 1.52 (2) $0.5 < L_l/L_{sn} < 1.8$ 1.33 1.27 1.47 1.41 (3) $0.7 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 2.0$ 1.35 1.29
1.07 0.94 (4) $2.0 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.6$ 2.62 3.02 2.56 2.59 (5) $0.70 < f_{l1}/f_{l2} < 2.00$ 1.481 0.804 1.849
1.294 (6) $1.0 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 3.0$ 2.40 2.64 1.75 1.57 (7) $1.0 < f_L/|f_n| < 5.0$ 1.84 1.72 3.18 3.07 (8) 70.0
 $< v_{dln} < 100.0$ 81.54 81.54 81.54 94.66 (9) $1.5 < f_{ln}/f_l < 3.0$ 2.14 2.32 1.99 2.47 (10) $35.0 < v_{dmp}$
 $- v_{dmn} < 70.0$ 52.41 49.22 54.6 49.22

Imaging Apparatus

(86) Next, a digital still camera (an imaging apparatus) using the zoom lens L0 according to any of the exemplary embodiments of the disclosure will be described with reference to FIG. 9. In FIG. 9, a camera body 10 and a lens apparatus 11 are illustrated. The lens apparatus 11 includes the zoom lens L0 according to one of the first to fourth exemplary embodiments.

(87) A solid-state image sensor (a photoelectric conversion device) 12, such as a CCD sensor or a CMOS sensor, is built in the camera body 10. The solid-state image sensor 12 receives an optical image formed by the lens apparatus 11 and photoelectrically converts the received optical image. The camera body 10 may be a single-lens reflex camera with a quick return mirror or a mirrorless camera without a quick return mirror.

(88) As described above, application of the zoom lens L0 according to any of the exemplary embodiments of the disclosure to an imaging apparatus such as a digital still camera makes it possible to provide high optical performance in a wide zoom range while achieving a size reduction and a wide angle of view.

(89) While the exemplary embodiments and examples of the disclosure have been described above,

the disclosure is not limited to the exemplary embodiments and the examples, and various combinations, modifications, and changes can be made within the scope of the disclosure.

(90) While the disclosure has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the disclosure is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(91) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-108063, filed Jun. 29, 2021, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. A zoom lens comprising a first lens unit having negative refractive power, a middle group consisting of a second lens unit having positive refractive power and a third lens unit disposed closer to an image side with respect to the second lens unit and having positive refractive power, and a last lens unit having positive refractive power that are arranged in an order from the object side to an image side, wherein a spacing between adjacent lens units, among the lens units, changes in zooming, wherein the zoom lens includes an aperture stop, wherein the first lens unit includes a first negative lens, a second negative lens, and a third negative lens that are arranged in the order from the object side to the image side, wherein a number of the negative lenses included in the first lens unit is three or four, wherein the middle group includes a plurality of cemented lenses each having a cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and includes a lens element L_n that is disposed closest to the image side among lens elements having negative refractive power included in the middle group, and wherein the following inequalities are satisfied:

$$1.2 < |f_1|/f_w < 2.0,$$

$$0.5 < L_{1s}/L_{sn} < 1.8, \text{ and}$$

$$0.7 < |f_n|/L_{sn} < 2.0, \text{ where } f_1 \text{ is a focal length of the first lens unit, } f_w \text{ is a focal length of the zoom lens at a wide angle end, } L_{1s} \text{ is a distance on an optical axis from a lens surface, of the zoom lens, disposed closest to the object side to the aperture stop at the wide angle end, } L_{sn} \text{ is a distance on the optical axis from the aperture stop to a lens surface, of the lens element } L_n, \text{ disposed closest to the image side at the wide angle end, and } f_n \text{ is a focal length of the lens element } L_n.$$

2. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the first lens unit includes, as the first negative lens, a negative lens L_{11} disposed closest to the object side, and wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$2.0 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.6, \text{ where } f_{mw} \text{ is a focal length of the middle group at the wide angle end.}$$

3. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the first lens unit includes, as the first negative lens, a negative lens L_{11} disposed closest to the object side and includes, as the second negative lens, a negative lens L_{12} disposed adjacent to an image side of the negative lens L_{11} , and wherein the following inequality is satisfied,

$$0.70 < f_{11}/f_{12} < 2.00, \text{ where } f_{11} \text{ is a focal length of the negative lens } L_{11}, \text{ and } f_{12} \text{ is a focal length of the negative lens } L_{12}.$$

4. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$1.0 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 3.0, \text{ where } s_{kn} \text{ is a distance on the optical axis from the lens surface, of the lens element } L_n, \text{ disposed closest to the image side to an image plane.}$$

5. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$1.0 < f_L/|f_n| < 5.0, \text{ where } f_L \text{ is a focal length of the last lens unit.}$$

6. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$70.0 < vd_{1n} < 100.0, \text{ where } vd_{1n} \text{ is an Abbe number of a negative lens } L_{1n} \text{ having a greatest Abbe number with respect to a d-line among the negative lenses included in the first lens unit.}$$

7. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$$1.5 < f_{1n}/f_1 < 3.0, \text{ where } f_{1n} \text{ is a focal length of a negative lens } L_{1n} \text{ having a greatest Abbe number}$$

with respect to a d-line among the negative lenses included in the first lens unit.

8. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein a cemented lens Lmc including a positive lens and a negative lens is disposed closest to the image side among the plurality of cemented lenses included in the middle group and each having the cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$35.0 < v_{dmp} - v_{dmn} < 70.0$, where v_{dmn} is an Abbe number, with respect to a d-line, of the negative lens included in the cemented lens Lmc, and v_{dmp} is an Abbe number, with respect to the d-line, of the positive lens included in the cemented lens Lmc.

9. The zoom lens according to claim 1, wherein, in zooming from the wide angle end to a telephoto end, the first lens unit moves toward the image side and then moves toward the object side.

10. An apparatus comprising: the zoom lens according to claim 1; and a sensor configured to receive an optical image formed by the zoom lens.

11. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the first lens unit includes, as the first negative lens, a negative lens L11 disposed closest to the object side, and wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$2.0 < f_{mw}/f_w < 3.6$, where f_{mw} is a focal length of the middle group at the wide angle end.

12. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the first lens unit includes, as the first negative lens, a negative lens L11 disposed closest to the object side and includes, as the second negative lens, a negative lens L12 disposed adjacent to an image side of the negative lens L11, and wherein the following inequality is satisfied,

$0.70 < f_{11}/f_{12} < 2.00$, where f_{11} is a focal length of the negative lens L11, and f_{12} is a focal length of the negative lens L12.

13. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$1.0 < |f_n|/s_{kn} < 3.0$, where s_{kn} is a distance on the optical axis from the lens surface, of the lens element L_n , disposed closest to the image side to an image plane.

14. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$1.0 < f_L/|f_n| < 5.0$, where f_L is a focal length of the last lens unit.

15. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$70.0 < v_{d1n} < 100.0$, where v_{d1n} is an Abbe number of a negative lens L1n having a greatest Abbe number with respect to a d-line among the negative lenses included in the first lens unit.

16. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$1.5 < f_{1n}/f_1 < 3.0$, where f_{1n} is a focal length of a negative lens L1n having a greatest Abbe number with respect to a d-line among the negative lenses included in the first lens unit.

17. The apparatus according to claim 10, wherein a cemented lens Lmc including a positive lens and a negative lens is disposed closest to the image side among the plurality of cemented lenses included in the middle group and each having the cemented surface that is convex toward the object side, and wherein the following inequality is satisfied:

$35.0 < v_{dmp} - v_{dmn} < 70.0$, where v_{dmn} is an Abbe number, with respect to a d-line, of the negative lens included in the cemented lens Lmc, and v_{dmp} is an Abbe number, with respect to the d-line, of the positive lens included in the cemented lens Lmc.
